

DIPLOMATIC EMERGENCY INSTRUMENT

The Last Resort Emergency Protocol

*A Hardened, Rapid-Deployment Military Freeze and De-escalation Framework
Between the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran*

Version 1.3 — 27 May 2026

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*"When comprehensive treaties fail, the wise diplomat asks not what can be won,
but what catastrophe can be prevented in the next 72 hours."*

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Preamble: The Edge of the Abyss

As of 27 May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand closer to a comprehensive peace agreement than at any point since hostilities began twelve weeks ago—and simultaneously closer to catastrophic escalation. The paradox is real: negotiations are "proceeding in an orderly and constructive manner," in the words of President Trump, even as U.S. Central Command conducts what it describes as "self-defense strikes" against Iranian missile sites and mine-laying vessels in the Strait of Hormuz.

The facts on the ground are these: a ceasefire brokered by Pakistan in early April technically holds but frays daily. U.S. naval forces enforce a blockade on Iranian ports. The Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed, keeping global oil prices elevated and energy markets volatile. Iran retains approximately 440 kilograms of uranium enriched to 60 percent purity—a short technical step from weapons grade. IAEA inspectors have not visited Iranian nuclear sites since the June 2025 strikes. On 25 May 2026, U.S. forces struck IRGC boats laying mines and a surface-to-air missile site at Bandar Abbas. Iran's Revolutionary Guard claims to have shot down a U.S. MQ-9 Reaper in response.

President Trump has stated that a deal is "largely negotiated" while cautioning negotiators "not to rush." Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has acknowledged "narrowing differences" while warning that "no one can claim" an agreement is imminent.

This is the landscape in which The Last Resort Emergency Protocol v1.3 exists. It is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It is not a permanent settlement of the nuclear file, the regional proxy question, or the sanctions architecture. It is something far more modest and far more urgent: a binding, verifiable, auto-renewing mechanism that freezes military escalation, secures the nuclear flashpoint, and reopens the Strait of Hormuz—creating the stable conditions under which comprehensive diplomacy can proceed.

Emergency Context

This Protocol is designed for signature within 72 hours. It requires no legislative ratification. It creates no permanent precedent. It exists solely to prevent the negotiations of late May 2026 from collapsing into renewed full-scale war. Version 1.3 hardens the firewall against ambiguity, standardizes operational definitions, and closes interpretation gaps identified in crisis simulations.

Purpose and Architecture

What This Protocol Does

This instrument is deliberately short. It resolves only whether the Parties will stop shooting long enough to negotiate. All other questions are explicitly deferred.

Dual-Clock Architecture. The Protocol operates on two independent clocks: the *military freeze* (Article I) auto-renews every 72 hours by silence — non-renewal requires only six hours' notice. The *economic and nuclear provisions* (Articles II–VII) run on a 30-day clock with 72-hour withdrawal notice. The two clocks are separable. A suspension of economic provisions does not automatically terminate the military freeze, and vice versa.

This Protocol creates a **minimum-viable stabilization zone** between the Parties. It addresses only those issues whose continued deadlock poses immediate risk of catastrophic escalation. All other matters—long-term enrichment rights, permanent facility status, full sanctions architecture, war reparations, ballistic missiles, regional proxy arrangements, Abraham Accords linkage—are explicitly deferred to comprehensive negotiations to be conducted during or after the interim period.

What This Protocol Does Not Do

- It does not permanently resolve Iran's nuclear program
- It does not require Iran to dismantle any centrifuge or facility
- It does not lift sanctions beyond targeted humanitarian and economic confidence measures
- It does not require either Party to alter its diplomatic relationships
- It does not link to the Abraham Accords or regional normalization
- It does not require either Party to describe the agreement using any particular terminology

No-Precedent Clause (Operative and Binding)

This Protocol establishes no legal or political precedent for any future negotiation. Each provision is tailored to the emergency circumstances of May 2026. No inference may be drawn regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed herein. The unique maritime coordination mechanisms apply exclusively to the Strait of Hormuz during the operational lifespan of this Protocol.

Core Operating Principles

All provisions of this Protocol are governed by four principles:

PRINCIPLE I: SYNCHRONIZED RECIPROCAL MOTION

Neither Party moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding U.S. commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Both governments can defend the sequencing as responding only when the other has moved first or simultaneously. If one side stops, the other stops. This eliminates the "who moves first" trap that has collapsed every previous negotiation.

PRINCIPLE II: TELEMETRY-FIRST VERIFICATION

Every commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If it cannot be verified by a neutral technical system, it does not belong in the operational text. The verification architecture is deliberately minimal: IAEA for nuclear, Oman for maritime, Swiss escrow for financial. No complex institutional hierarchy. No voting bodies. No weighted breach indices.

PRINCIPLE III: ROLLBACK, NOT COLLAPSE

If either Party breaches, the Protocol does not terminate. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless. Ambiguity triggers investigation, not punishment. Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations trigger full review—and even then, military response is not embedded in the Protocol. Breach does not equal war. It equals structured review and diplomatic re-engagement.

PRINCIPLE IV: FIREWALL PRINCIPLE

Failure on one front does not collapse another. The nuclear freeze, Hormuz reopening, and military freeze are separable. Each may survive the suspension of others. A breach in one Article does not automatically cascade to any other Article unless explicitly linked in the operative text.

PRINCIPLE V: GOOD FAITH OPERATION

Both Parties commit to operate this Protocol in good faith. Neither Party shall deliberately engage in cyber-spoofing, signal-jamming, data falsification, or other technical interference with the Joint Hotline, Shared Dashboard, IAEA monitoring systems, or any other verification channel established under this Protocol. Any verified act of deliberate technical sabotage against the Protocol's own monitoring infrastructure constitutes a Tier 3 breach, regardless of whether such sabotage is accompanied by a military violation.

Annex C: Technical Definitions (Operative)

The following definitions are operative and binding throughout this Protocol. They are placed at the front of the instrument to ensure that all subsequent articles are interpreted through these standardized meanings.

C.1 "Imminent Physical Threat" (Article I.1)

For purposes of the operational freeze, an "imminent physical threat" is defined as a verifiable, time-bound indication of hostile military action that meets **at least two** of the following three criteria:

CRITERION	TECHNICAL STANDARD
Proximate positioning	Armed military assets (aircraft, naval vessels, missile batteries, ground forces) positioned within weapons-range of the other Party's forces or territory, without advance notification through the Joint Hotline
Active weapons system preparation	Verified thermal or electronic signatures consistent with weapons system warm-up, targeting radar activation, or missile fueling, detected by satellite or Omani observation
Credible intelligence convergence	At least two independent intelligence sources (human, signals, or imagery) confirm hostile intent within a 24-hour operational window

Subjective fear, unverified media reports, or single-source intelligence alone do not constitute an imminent physical threat under this Protocol.

C.2 "Humanitarian Relief" — Codified Categories (Article IV)

For purposes of Article IV, "humanitarian relief" is limited to goods falling within the following Harmonized Tariff Schedule (HTS) categories:

CATEGORY	HTS CHAPTER HEADINGS	EXAMPLES
Medicine and pharmaceuticals	and HTS Chapters 30	Prescription drugs, vaccines, insulin, antibiotics, diagnostic reagents
Medical equipment and supplies	and HTS Chapters 9018–9022	Syringes, bandages, surgical instruments, X-ray equipment, ventilators
Food and agricultural inputs	HTS Chapters 1–24 (selected)	Wheat, rice, infant formula, vegetable oils, legumes, fertilizer (Ch. 31)
Agricultural machinery	HTS Chapter 8432–8436	Irrigation equipment, harvesters, seeders, food processing machinery
Civilian aviation safety	HTS Chapter 8803–8805	Aircraft spare parts, navigation instruments, landing gear components
Water and sanitation	HTS Chapters 8421, 3917	Water purification equipment, pipes, pumps, filtration membranes

Any dispute over whether a specific good falls within these categories shall be resolved by the UN OCHA/WHO administrator within 48 hours. The administrator's determination is binding for purposes of humanitarian channel access.

C.3 "Significant Casualties" — Quantified Thresholds (Article VIII)

For purposes of Article VIII (Optional Israel-Lebanon-Hezbollah Annex), the following casualty thresholds apply:

TERM	DEFINITION	PROTOCOL EFFECT
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Minor incident	0–2 fatalities or 0–9 wounded across all parties	Lebanon-track reporting only; Core Protocol unaffected
Moderate incident	3–9 fatalities or 10–49 wounded	Lebanon-track escalation review; 72-hour diplomatic consult; Core Protocol unaffected
Significant casualties	10+ fatalities or 50+ wounded in a single event or 24-hour period	Lebanon-track emergency session; UNSC notification required; Core Protocol still protected by Firewall unless both Parties separately agree to suspend

C.4 "Known Hezbollah Launch Points" (Article VIII)

For purposes of LAF deployment obligations under Article VIII, "known Hezbollah launch points" means locations within southern Lebanon (south of the Litani River) that have been verified by at least two of the following sources as active rocket, missile, or drone launch sites within the 180 days prior to Protocol signature:

1. UNIFIL incident reports filed under UN Security Council Resolution 1701
2. Israeli Defence Force intelligence shared with the Joint Facilitation and Monitoring Cell (JFMC)
3. Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF) own internal mapping, provided to the JFMC within 7 days of Annex activation

The JFMC shall publish a consolidated, classified map of these locations within 14 days of Annex activation. Updates shall occur every 30 days.

C.5 "Written Non-Renewal Notice" — Standardized Format (Article VII)

For purposes of Article VII.1, a valid "written non-renewal notice" must meet all of the following criteria:

- Delivered as a **diplomatic note verbale** (not email, SMS, or verbal communication)
- Addressed to the Facilitating State's accredited mission in both capitals
- Bears the signature of the Minister of Foreign Affairs or equivalent Cabinet-rank official
- Includes the specific Protocol article under which non-renewal is invoked
- Received by the Facilitating State's mission during business hours (09:00–17:00 local time, Monday–Friday); notices received outside these hours are deemed received at 09:00 the next business day

The 48-hour non-renewal countdown begins upon Facilitating State confirmation of receipt, transmitted via the Joint Hotline within 2 hours of physical receipt.

Article I: The 72-Hour Auto-Renewing Military Freeze

1.1 Simultaneous Operational Freeze

Upon signature of this Protocol, both Parties shall immediately implement a legally binding cessation of offensive military operations:

- **The United States shall suspend:** all offensive airstrikes, naval bombardment, and blockade enforcement actions against Iranian targets; all offensive cyber operations against Iranian nuclear monitoring systems, banking infrastructure, and maritime navigation systems; and shall transition naval forces to a stand-off posture maintaining a minimum 5-nautical-mile distance from Iranian territorial waters' baseline in the Strait, and a minimum 3-nautical-mile distance from Iranian-flagged vessels not engaged in hostile acts. **Self-defence exception:** Legitimate self-defence responses to incoming kinetic attack are permitted only in response to actual weapons fire or imminent physical threat to personnel, where "imminent" means within 15 minutes of launch detection or visual acquisition of targeting. Surveillance, signalling, posturing, and cyber intrusion do not qualify.
- **The Islamic Republic of Iran shall suspend:** all offensive military operations against U.S. forces and interests, including proxy kinetic actions; all enrichment activity above 3.67 percent U-235; all mine-laying, naval interdiction, and harassment operations in the Strait of Hormuz; and all offensive cyber operations against U.S. critical infrastructure.

1.2 The Auto-Renewing Mechanism

The military freeze operates as a **self-renewing 72-hour module**. If both Parties confirm compliance at Hour 71 through the Joint Hotline, the module automatically renews for another 72 hours. This mechanism continues indefinitely until either Party provides 48 hours' written notice of non-renewal to the Facilitating State in accordance with the standardized format defined in Annex C.5, or until the Protocol is superseded by a comprehensive agreement.

WHY THIS WORKS

Separating the ceasefire clock (72-hour loops) from the implementation clock (30-day phases) neutralizes the "negotiation about negotiation" trap. If comprehensive talks stall on Day 14 over implementation details, the guns do not automatically resume firing. The 72-hour military freeze continues auto-renewing quietly in the background, creating the stability necessary for diplomacy to proceed without the constant threat of reversion to open hostilities.

1.3 Verification of the Freeze

PARTY		VERIFICATION METHOD	VERIFIER		WINDOW
Iran	(enrichment freeze)	Online Enrichment Monitors (OLEM) + real-time camera feeds at Natanz and Fordow	IAEA		Immediate
Iran (naval/military)		AIS vessel tracking + satellite thermal imaging + Omani naval observation	Oman		3-7 days
U.S. (naval posture)		AIS tracking of U.S. naval positions + Omani naval observation	Oman		3-7 days
U.S.	(no new sanctions)	OFAC database monitoring via Shared Dashboard	Swiss agent	escrow	7 days

The 72-hour clock starts on IAEA confirmation of enrichment freeze, not physical arrival of inspectors. U.S. operational compliance begins upon signature and is verified by Omani naval observers and Lloyd's List AIS tracking.

1.4 Tiered Incident Response Architecture

A single alleged violation does not suspend this Protocol. Accidents, miscommunications, and deliberate provocations by spoilers will occur. The Protocol survives them through the tiered response architecture below.

TIER	TRIGGER	PROTOCOL EFFECT	TIMELINE
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Tier 1: Single Incident	One alleged violation; no casualties; no confirmed hostile intent	JFMC logs incident; enhanced monitoring of affected sector; no consequences	4-hour JFMC assessment
Tier 2: Pattern or Lethal Strike	Three Tier 1 incidents within 24 hours; OR one incident causing 1–9 fatalities; OR confirmed proxy action below 10-casualty threshold	Consultation window opens; next economic tranche held; non-humanitarian benefits may pause	48-hour consultation (Article VI)
Tier 3: Large-Scale Offensive	Confirmed state-ordered kinetic attack; OR 10+ casualties in single event; OR confirmed enrichment above 60%; OR removal of IAEA seals	Cooling-Off Period activates; all discretionary benefits frozen; JFMC emergency session convened	72-hour Cooling-Off (Article VI.1)
Tier 4: Collapse	Tier 3 finding plus refusal to enter Cooling-Off; OR deliberate cyber-spoofing of monitoring infrastructure; OR kinetic attack on the other Party's territory	Protocol enters full suspension; Reconstitution Conference convened within 14 days	14 days (Article VI.5)

1.4.1 Third-Party Spoiler Protocol

If an incident is clearly caused by a non-signatory actor (e.g., ISIS, unaffiliated militia, criminal organization, or unidentified third party), the Joint Facilitation and Monitoring Cell (JFMC) shall follow this protocol:

- 1. Within 4 hours:** JFMC issues a preliminary "non-attribution" notice to all Parties via the Shared Dashboard, suspending blame-shifting
- 2. Within 24 hours:** JFMC publishes a public incident summary with known facts, explicitly noting non-signatory origin if evidence supports it
- 3. Within 48 hours:** JFMC conducts a fact-finding assessment with participation from all Parties; no Party may take military action against the other during this window
- 4. Default finding:** If attribution remains inconclusive after 48 hours, the incident is classified as "non-attributable third-party action" and does not trigger any tier escalation

This protocol exists because both Parties have limited control over proxy actors, and because the history of U.S.-Iran negotiations is littered with deals collapsed by third-party spoilers. What happens in Lebanon, Yemen, or Gaza stays in those theaters. It cannot blow back onto the core U.S.-Iran military freeze.

1.4.2 Data Mirroring Rule

1.5 The Joint Freeze Monitoring Cell (JFMC)

Oman, Qatar, and the United States each designate a senior diplomatic officer as Compliance Monitor, forming the **Joint Freeze Monitoring Cell (JFMC)**. The JFMC receives reports, assesses them against definitions in this Protocol, and communicates findings within 4 hours. It has no authority to suspend the freeze or declare breach—only to inform. The JFMC shall operate through the LREP Secure Portal established under Article V.5.2.

The JFMC is constituted within 24 hours of Protocol signature. Its operating procedures are published on the Shared Dashboard. All findings are non-binding recommendations to the Parties and the Facilitating State.

All incident reports, attribution assessments, verification data, and compliance determinations published on the Shared Dashboard shall be transmitted simultaneously to all Parties via the encrypted JFMC communication portal. No Party shall receive preferential early access. All data is time-stamped and cryptographically signed to prevent tampering.

Article II: Nuclear Flashpoint Resolution

2.1 The HEU Custody Compromise

President Trump has demanded physical control of Iran's approximately 400 kg of highly enriched uranium. Iran has declared, as a binding sovereign position, that its enriched uranium must remain under Iranian legal title and within Iranian territory during any verification period. This Protocol creates a third path that satisfies both Parties' essential requirements:

THE OMAN ESCROW SOLUTION

The entire stockpile of all material with isotopic concentration of U-235 exceeding 20 percent, regardless of chemical form (UF₆, oxide, metal, or other compounds) shall be consolidated, inventoried, and transported to an **IAEA-monitored escrow facility in Muscat, Oman**—not the United States—within 14 days of Protocol activation. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU at all times. The IAEA holds physical custody only. The Sultanate of Oman serves as the escrow guarantor state. If Oman is unable or unwilling to serve within 72 hours of signature, the State of Qatar shall serve as alternate escrow guarantor. If Qatar is also unavailable, Switzerland shall serve as tertiary guarantor.

What President Trump gains: Every gram of Iran's HEU stockpile is located, sealed, under international control, and physically outside Iranian territory. U.S. technical personnel receive real-time monitoring access via encrypted telemetry. Consolidation to one facility eliminates the risk of hidden breakout material. The material cannot be weaponized without detection.

What Iran retains: The HEU never enters U.S. custody. Legal title remains with the Central Bank of Iran. The IAEA may not transfer, sell, or dispose of the material without written consent. Iranian observers accompany every stage of packaging and transit. A friendly Islamic state (Oman) hosts the material. Iran can frame this as placing its material in international trust, not delivering it to an adversary.

2.2 Enrichment Freeze

Concurrent with HEU consolidation, Iran shall halt all enrichment above 3.67 percent U-235 effective immediately upon signature. This is a 30-day freeze, not a permanent ban. No centrifuge is destroyed. No facility is dismantled. The freeze is verified by Online Enrichment Monitors (OLEM) and confirmed by IAEA on-site inspectors within 7 days.

Iran retains the right to enrich uranium to 3.67 percent at Natanz for civilian purposes. All enrichment infrastructure above 3.67 percent is placed under IAEA seal with continuous camera monitoring. Fordow and all non-Natanz facilities are placed in non-operational status under seal.

2.3 Verification Timeline

PHASE	CLOCK TIME	ACTION	VERIFIER
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T+0	Day 1	Protocol activates; enrichment freeze begins	OLEM (immediate)
T+12h	Day 1	IAEA inspectors arrive; begin physical inventory of HEU. If IAEA cannot deploy within 12 hours, remote verification via OLEM and encrypted camera feeds accepted for first 72 hours.	IAEA / Remote
T+24h	Day 2	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	IAEA
T+48h	Day 3	Cylinders loaded into IAEA-certified secure casks; tamper-evident seals applied	IAEA
T+7d	Day 7	Convoy departs for Oman under armed IAEA guard; continuous satellite surveillance	IAEA + Oman
T+14d	Day 14	HEU placed in IAEA custody at Muscat escrow facility; dual-lock custody initiated	IAEA + Oman

The 14-day timeline may be extended by up to 7 additional days upon request through the Facilitating State if verified administrative, technical, or logistical constraints arise. Such delays do not constitute breach.

Article III: Strait of Hormuz Emergency Reopening

3.1 Emergency Joint Transit Coordination

Within 72 hours of Protocol signature, a provisional **Joint Transit Coordination Cell (JTCC)** shall be established at Bandar Abbas (Iranian side) and Khasab (Omani side), staffed by personnel from Iran, the United States, and Oman. The JTCC does not stop, board, or search vessels. Its function is purely coordinative: monitor AIS data, coordinate patrol schedules, respond to distress calls, and ensure uninterrupted commercial transit. Iran commits that no IRGC naval vessel shall approach within 500 metres of any transiting commercial vessel without prior notification to the JTCC. Boarding, inspection, or diversion of vessels is prohibited during the interim period.

3.2 The PGSA Recognition Compromise

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), established by Iran on 5 May 2026, is recognized as the designated Iranian operational body for transit coordination within Iranian territorial waters for the duration of this Protocol. This Protocol does not confer or withhold international legal status upon the PGSA. It simply treats the Authority as the existing operational entity through which transit coordination occurs. All PGSA transit permits bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran (domestic) and JTCC-Authorized (international).

3.3 No Unilateral Tolls

During the 30-day interim period, no transit fees or tolls shall be collected by any Party. This addresses President Trump's explicit demand: "We don't want tolls." The cost of JTCC operations shall be borne by a neutral Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund established under Article IV, not by vessel operators.

3.4 Synchronized Naval Posture

Both Parties shall maintain a symmetrical 5-nautical-mile stand-off distance from the Strait transit corridor during the interim period. Neither Party shall conduct provocative naval maneuvers, boarding operations, or interdiction actions within the transit corridor. Patrol coordination schedules shall be published weekly to all JTCC members.

3.5 Sanctions Freeze Linked to Strait

Concurrent with Strait reopening, the United States shall freeze all new sanctions designations on Iranian maritime, oil, and financial sectors for the duration of this Protocol. If the United States designates new Iranian entities in these sectors while Hormuz is open, Iran may suspend JTCC cooperation without triggering breach. This provision links sanctions behaviour to maritime cooperation.

3.6 What Each Party Gains

For President Trump: The Strait is open. Tolls are suspended. American and allied vessels transit without interference. U.S. naval forces operate with clear rules of engagement. Global energy flows resume, stabilizing oil markets and U.S. gasoline prices.

For Iran: The PGSA is acknowledged as the operational coordination body. Iranian personnel staff the Bandar Abbas coordination center. Iran's sovereignty over adjacent territorial waters is not challenged. The principle of Iranian involvement in Strait governance is recognized. Iranian oil exports can resume through the reopened waterway.

Article IV: Humanitarian Corridor and Economic Release Valve

4.1 Immediate Humanitarian Release (Day 1)

Upon signature of this Protocol and concurrent activation of the military freeze, the United States shall authorize the release of **\$250 million via Swiss escrow** for immediate humanitarian purposes. The specific categories of goods qualifying as "humanitarian relief" are defined in Annex C.2 (HTS Codification). This release is not contingent on IAEA verification. It is contingent solely on simultaneous activation of the military freeze by both Parties. This is Day-One relief for the Iranian population.

4.2 Non-Negotiable Humanitarian Corridor

Regardless of any other provision, and regardless of any breach, dispute, or suspension, a **zero-cost, zero-delay humanitarian corridor** through the Strait of Hormuz is established effective immediately upon entry into force. This corridor is legally non-divertible and inviolable. The UN OCHA/WHO administrator holds sole disbursement authority. Any attempt to redirect, condition, or delay humanitarian funds triggers automatic IAEA investigation but does not affect the humanitarian flow itself. Medicine, food, and medical equipment flows continue even if all other provisions collapse.

4.3 Economic Confidence Measures (Day 7)

Within 7 days of verified HEU consolidation beginning (Article II), the United States shall:

1. Issue an OFAC general license authorizing the sale of civilian aircraft spare parts to Iran for 30 days;
2. Permit the export of agricultural goods and medical equipment under existing humanitarian exemptions without additional licensing requirements;
3. Freeze all new sanctions designations for the duration of the Protocol.

4.4 Frozen Asset Release (Day 14)

Upon IAEA confirmation that HEU has been placed in Oman escrow custody, **25 percent of frozen Iranian assets** shall be released to Iranian control via the Central Bank of Oman as escrow agent. The remaining 75 percent remains held pending comprehensive negotiation. This is a 25/75 split that partially addresses both Parties' positions: Iran receives immediate, tangible economic benefit; the United States retains the majority of leverage for the comprehensive deal.

4.5 Omani Verification for Humanitarian Vessels

Oman's Royal Navy serves as sole verification and escort authority for humanitarian vessels transiting the Strait. Verification is limited to confirming cargo manifests against WHO/ICRC certification against the HTS categories defined in Annex C.2. Oman may not deny, delay, or inspect for any other purpose. This removes both the United States and Iran from the humanitarian verification chain, reducing pretext for interdiction.

4.6 Iran's Reciprocal Commitments

In synchronized motion, Iran shall:

1. Permit unrestricted humanitarian vessel transit through the Strait of Hormuz at zero cost;
2. Not interfere with the operations of humanitarian organizations (UN, ICRC, WHO) in Iranian waters or airspace;
3. Cooperate with JTCC coordination functions and publish weekly patrol schedules.

Article V: Minimum Viable Verification

5.1 Design Philosophy

Previous frameworks created elaborate institutional architectures: Joint Commissions, subcommittees, working groups, weighted breach indices, and complex voting procedures. This Protocol creates three bodies. That is all. Each has one job, reports directly to both Parties, and publishes findings to a shared digital dashboard.

BODY	LOCATION	FUNCTION	STAFF
Joint Hotline	Muscat, Oman	24/7 communication between senior U.S. and Iranian officials; compliance confirmation; crisis response	Omani duty officers (3 per shift)
Shared Dashboard	Hosted by Switzerland; mirrored in Oman	Publishes real-time data on verification, compliance, asset transfers, and naval posture	Neutral IT team (4 people)
Facilitator's Office	Geneva (primary); Muscat (maritime backup)	Manages escrow, convenes mediation, publishes compliance reports	Neutral diplomatic staff (6 people)

5.2 Standardized Reporting Channels (Encrypted JFMC Portal)

All Parties shall communicate with the Joint Facilitation and Monitoring Cell (JFMC) exclusively through a **dedicated, encrypted, redundant digital communication portal** (the "LREP Secure Portal"). The Portal shall meet the following specifications:

- **Encryption:** End-to-end AES-256 encryption with TLS 1.3 transport security
- **Redundancy:** Primary server hosted in Switzerland; failover mirror in Muscat, Oman; both independently powered and networked
- **Authentication:** Multi-factor authentication with hardware security tokens issued to each Party's designated representatives
- **Logging:** Immutable, cryptographically signed audit trail of all submissions, with timestamps in UTC
- **Accessibility:** Web-based interface accessible from any internet-connected device; mobile app for crisis notifications
- **Language:** Supports English, Persian, and Arabic with certified diplomatic translation

Disparate communication methods (email, telephone, fax, unencrypted messaging) may be used for preliminary contact but do not constitute formal notification under this Protocol. All formal notifications, incident reports, and compliance confirmations must be submitted through the LREP Secure Portal to be legally valid.

5.3 Five-Channel Verification

Compliance is verified through five independent channels. No single channel's report is determinative. Convergence of at least three channels is required for any compliance determination:

- 1. **IAEA Technical Verification:** On-site inspectors, OLEM sensors, mass spectrometry, camera feeds
- 2. **Neutral-State Naval Observation:** Omani naval observers log positions and movements of both Parties' forces
- 3. **Commercial AIS/Satellite Tracking:** Lloyd's List and independent maritime monitors confirm Hormuz transit volumes
- 4. **Financial Escrow Verification:** Swiss Financial Cell confirms asset transfers and humanitarian disbursements
- 5. **Joint Hotline Assessment:** Daily operational reporting from both Parties through the Muscat channel

5.4 Four-Tier Breach Response

TIER	TRIGGER	RESPONSE	WHAT SURVIVES
Tier 1: Incident	Single alleged violation; no casualties; minor procedural deviation; delayed reporting; minor telemetry anomaly	7-day remediation. Enhanced monitoring. No consequences.	All provisions continue.
Tier 2: Pattern	Three Tier 1 incidents within 24 hours; OR significant operational non-compliance (enrichment above 3.67% detected; unauthorized HEU access attempt); OR one incident causing 1–9 fatalities	Next economic tranche held. 14-day remediation window opens. Non-humanitarian benefits may pause.	Humanitarian channel. Military freeze. Enrichment cap monitoring. Hotline.
Tier 3: Crisis	Confirmed state-ordered kinetic attack; OR 10+ casualties in single event; OR confirmed enrichment above 60%; OR removal of IAEA seals; OR deliberate cyber-spoofing of monitoring infrastructure	Cooling-Off Period activates. All pending benefits frozen. Pre-Protocol sanctions posture resumes.	Humanitarian corridor. IAEA baseline monitoring. Ceasefire hotline active for 180 days. HEU remains in IAEA custody.

Tier 4:	Tier 3 finding plus refusal to enter Protocol enters full suspension. Humanitarian corridor under
Collapse	Cooling-Off; OR kinetic attack on Reconstitution Conference UN mandate only. Minimum the other Party's territory; OR convened within 14 days. UN Viable Core (Article VII.3) sustained monitoring sabotage after Security Council notified. persists for 180 days. warning

5.5 Verification Evidence Requirements

When reporting a Tier 1 incident, the reporting Party shall provide **specific, time-stamped evidence** through the LREP Secure Portal:

INCIDENT TYPE	REQUIRED EVIDENCE	MINIMUM STANDARD
Naval posture violation	AIS track data + satellite imagery + Omani observer log	Time-stamped within 15 minutes of alleged violation
Enrichment cap breach	OLEM anomaly report + IAEA inspector photograph + mass spectrometry log	Chain-of-custody documentation from IAEA
Sanctions designation freeze breach	OFAC database screenshot + legal citation + timestamp	Date-stamped OFAC Federal Register entry
Humanitarian channel interference	Vessel manifest + UN OCHA report + port authority log	Certified by UN official or port authority
Cyber interference with monitoring	Network traffic logs + forensic analysis + neutral IT team report	Attribution confidence of 90% or higher

Reports submitted without the required evidence shall be logged but do not trigger the 4-hour consultation window. The JFMC shall notify the reporting Party of the evidentiary deficiency within 2 hours. The 4-hour window begins only upon receipt of complete evidence.

5.6 Facilitator Authority Enhancement

The Facilitating States (Oman and Qatar) are empowered to:

- 1. **Suggest fact-finding missions** for contested incidents without requiring prior Party consent; such missions deploy within 24 hours and consist of neutral military observers

2. **Issue preliminary non-binding assessments** within 12 hours of any Tier 1 or Tier 2 incident
3. **Convene emergency JFMC sessions** when three or more incidents occur within a 72-hour period, regardless of whether any Party has requested consultation
4. **Recommend automatic protocol extensions** of up to 48 hours if technical difficulties prevent scheduled diplomatic consultations

Key Design Feature

Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations reach Tier 3. Ambiguity, technical glitches, and administrative delays are Tier 1. No military authorization is embedded in any tier. Breach does not equal war. The Good Faith Clause (Principle IV) ensures that deliberate sabotage of the Protocol's own monitoring systems is treated as seriously as a kinetic breach.

Article VI: Dispute Resolution and Cooling-Off

6.1 Mandatory Cooling-Off Period

If disagreement occurs and attribution is unclear, **all escalation freezes automatically** for a mandatory 24-to-72-hour Cooling-Off Period. Neither Party may take escalatory military action during this period. The Facilitating State investigates and recommends resolution within 72 hours. This cooling-off is automatic—it does not require either Party to request it. It activates upon any Tier 2 or Tier 3 trigger.

6.2 Rapid Consultation

Any Party may request emergency consultation within 4 hours of any perceived violation. The other Party shall respond within 12 hours. Consultation occurs through the Joint Hotline in Muscat or via the Facilitator's Office in Geneva. If a Party fails to respond to a JFMC inquiry within the 4-hour window, the JFMC may, for monitoring purposes only, record the allegation as provisionally unchallenged. This recording does not constitute a legal finding of breach but triggers enhanced verification of the alleged activity. The non-responding Party may submit a rebuttal at any time within the subsequent 48 hours.

6.3 Neutral Mediation

If direct consultation fails to resolve the dispute within 48 hours, the neutral chair of the Facilitator's Office (or the UN Secretary-General's representative) shall mediate. Mediation is non-binding but its

recommendations are published and carry significant political weight.

6.4 No Unilateral Military Response

Neither Party shall undertake military action in response to a perceived breach without first exhausting the dispute resolution procedures in this Article, except in the case of verified imminent armed attack under UN Charter Article 51. Premature military response forfeits the responding Party's next scheduled benefit tranche.

6.5 Reconstitution Commitment

If the Protocol enters full suspension, both Parties commit to attend a **Reconstitution Conference within 14 days**, hosted by the Facilitating State, to attempt restoration of the minimum viable core: military freeze, humanitarian corridor, and IAEA baseline monitoring.

6.6 Emergency Technical Extension

If technical difficulties (communication system failure, verifier unavailability, force majeure) prevent the commencement or continuation of scheduled comprehensive negotiations, the Facilitating State may declare a **24-hour emergency extension** of the Protocol. This extension does not require Party consent but must be:

- Published on the Shared Dashboard within 1 hour of declaration
- Accompanied by a technical explanation of the difficulty
- Limited to 24 hours, renewable once for an additional 24 hours if the difficulty persists
- Automatically terminated once the difficulty is resolved

Article VII: Duration, Exit and Graduation

7.1 30-Day Initial Duration

This Protocol enters into force upon signature and remains in force for an initial period of 30 days. It may be extended by mutual written consent of both Parties for additional 30-day periods without limit. Extension by silence: if neither Party provides written notice of non-extension at least 48 hours before expiration in the standardized format defined in Annex C.5, the Protocol automatically renews for another 30 days.

7.2 Graduation Pathway

The express purpose of this Protocol is to create the stable conditions necessary for comprehensive peace negotiations. Within 14 days of signature, both Parties commit to commence good-faith comprehensive negotiations toward a permanent agreement addressing all outstanding issues: long-term enrichment parameters, permanent facility status, full sanctions relief architecture, regional security arrangements, and all other matters deferred by this Protocol.

7.3 Minimum Viable Core

Under all circumstances, including total Protocol suspension, three elements survive:

1. The military-to-military hotline remains active for 180 days;
2. The humanitarian corridor through Hormuz continues at zero cost under UN mandate;
3. The emergency diplomatic channel stays open for 180 days;
4. HEU remains in IAEA custody at the Oman escrow facility pending further negotiation.

7.4 Dual-Track Exit Provisions

The Protocol operates on two exit clocks. **For the military freeze module (Article I) only:** non-renewal requires six hours' advance notice, sufficient time for negotiators to reach safety. Silence equals continuation of the freeze module. **For all other provisions (nuclear, economic, Hormuz):** either Party may withdraw with 72 hours' written notice in the standardized format defined in Annex C.5. Withdrawal does not trigger automatic resumption of hostilities. The 72-hour auto-renewing ceasefire module continues until its natural expiration unless explicitly non-renewed. HEU remains in IAEA custody for 30 days following withdrawal, after which return procedures under Article 7.5 apply.

7.5 HEU Return Mechanism

If no comprehensive agreement supersedes this Protocol within 180 days of entry into force, either Party may request the Facilitator to convene a return conference. The default rule is return of HEU to Iranian sovereign control under IAEA monitoring, with transport costs borne equally. Neither Party may unilaterally seize or block return. Return shall be completed within 30 days of conference convening.

7.6 Supersession

This Protocol is automatically superseded upon entry into force of any comprehensive agreement between the Parties. All escrowed materials, ongoing verification activities, and institutional arrangements transition seamlessly into the successor framework unless otherwise agreed.

Article VIII: Optional Israel-Lebanon-Hezbollah Military Freeze (Annex)

Optional Annex — Not Required for Core Protocol Entry into Force

This Article is an **optional annex** that may be activated by mutual written consent of the United States, the Islamic Republic of Iran, and the State of Israel within 72 hours of Core Protocol signature. It does not form part of the mandatory obligations under Articles I through VII. Its sole purpose is to prevent escalation on the Israel-Lebanon front from collapsing the core U.S.-Iran de-escalation framework. If this Annex is not activated, the Core Protocol remains fully operative without it.

8.1 Dossier Isolation Firewall

The most dangerous structural vulnerability in any U.S.-Iran agreement is the risk that a Hezbollah strike into northern Israel or an Israeli air strike on a Hezbollah position in southern Lebanon triggers a chain reaction that collapses the core nuclear and maritime deal. This Annex creates a **binding structural firewall** that explicitly prohibits either the United States or Iran from using incidents, friction, or localized military activity in southern Lebanon as justification for suspending or collapsing Articles I through VII of this Protocol.

Operative Principle: The Lebanon file and the U.S.-Iran nuclear/maritime file are legally and operationally segregated. What happens in Lebanon stays in Lebanon — it cannot blow back onto Hormuz.

8.2 Collapse Threshold and LAF Deployment

This Annex collapses only if **(a)** a confirmed Hezbollah strike causes ten or more Israeli casualties within a single 24-hour period, or **(b)** the Lebanese government refuses or fails to deploy LAF under Article 8.2 within 12 hours of Annex activation. A Hezbollah strike below 10 casualties does not collapse the Annex. Israel may respond defensively at the source of fire without invalidating the broader pause.

8.2.1 Lebanese Armed Forces Deployment

The Lebanese Armed Forces will deploy to known Hezbollah launch points in southern Lebanon (as defined in Annex C.4) and physically interpose between launch teams and the border. The LAF is not required to disarm Hezbollah units—only to physically prevent firing. Deployment shall be verified through UNIFIL coordination and daily reporting to the JFMC.

8.2.2 Casualty Threshold Table

CASUALTY LEVEL	DEFINITION	ANNEX EFFECT	CORE PROTOCOL EFFECT
Minor	0–2 fatalities or 0–9 wounded	Incident logged; enhanced monitoring	NONE — Firewall protected
Moderate	3–9 fatalities or 10–49 wounded	72-hour diplomatic consult; JFMC review	NONE — Firewall protected
Significant	10+ fatalities or 50+ wounded in 24 hours	Annex may collapse; emergency session	NONE — Firewall protected unless both Parties agree

8.3 Formalized Iranian Commitment Letter (Binding Annex)

The private Iranian letter regarding Hezbollah influence transmitted through Omani channels on [DATE] is hereby converted into a **formal, binding, classified annex** to this Protocol ("Annex H — Iranian Hezbollah Commitment Letter"). The Letter shall:

- Be deposited with the Facilitating State and classified at the "Restricted" level
- Form part of the binding obligations of this Protocol upon Annex activation
- Be subject to the same verification and dispute resolution procedures as all other Annex provisions
- Not be made public without mutual consent of all Annex parties
- Be summarized in unclassified form on the Shared Dashboard for transparency purposes

8.4 Hezbollah Operational Pause

If this Annex is activated, Iran commits to transmit immediate, formal instructions to Hezbollah leadership for a structured, time-limited operational de-escalation concurrent with the Core Protocol timeline. This is not disarmament, surrender, or political concession:

PHASE	DURATION	HEZBOLLAH PARAMETERS	ISRAELI RECIPROCAL
Phase 1	Days 1–30	Cessation of cross-border rocket and drone attacks; defensive positions only; no new weapons transfers from Iran	Suspension of offensive air strikes against Hezbollah positions for 30 days; IDF maintains defensive posture only
Phase 2	Days 31–90	Continued cessation of offensive operations; forces remain in defensive positions; no infiltration across the Blue Line	Extension of air strike moratorium contingent on 90 days verified Hezbollah restraint
Phase 3	Days 91–180	Exploration of structured de-escalation through parallel diplomatic track; political and humanitarian engagement permitted	Israeli restrictions reviewed at Day 180 milestone; further confidence-building measures considered

8.5 LAF Deployment Clarification

The Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF) shall deploy to **known Hezbollah launch points** as defined in Annex C.4 within 72 hours of Annex activation. The scope of LAF responsibility is limited to:

- Physical presence and patrol at designated launch point locations
- Reporting of any unauthorized military activity to the JFMC within 4 hours
- Coordination with UNIFIL forces along the Blue Line

The LAF is not required to engage in armed confrontation with Hezbollah forces. Its role is observation, reporting, and de-escalation through presence. Any dispute over whether a location qualifies as a "known Hezbollah launch point" shall be resolved by majority vote of the JFMC within 24 hours.

8.6 Verification Architecture

The Hezbollah operational pause is verified through four independent channels: (1) **UNIFIL ground patrols** — daily patrols along the Blue Line with incident logging published to the Shared Dashboard; (2) **Israeli intelligence assessment** — weekly classified brief with sanitized summary; (3) **Lebanese Armed Forces liaison** — daily reporting from LAF command to the Oman Liaison Office; (4) **SEAC pattern analysis** — automated detection of supply route activity and weapons convoy movement. All four channels must show compliance before the pause is considered verified.

8.7 Non-Compliance Consequences (Isolated to Lebanon Track)

If any channel reports significant Hezbollah offensive action: (1) 24-hour verification window — all four channels confirm; (2) if confirmed, Iran has 72 hours to transmit renewed de-escalation instructions through the Oman back-channel; (3) if Iran de-escalates within 72 hours, pause resumes with enhanced monitoring; (4) if Iran does not de-escalate, Israel may resume defensive air strikes limited to specific positions involved — not blanket escalation; (5) **under no circumstances does a Hezbollah incident trigger suspension of Core Protocol Articles I through VII.**

8.8 Parallel Diplomatic Track

This Annex creates a **Levant Regional Basket** — a parallel diplomatic track, separate from the Core Protocol, for long-term Israel-Lebanon stability. The Basket addresses: Blue Line demarcation, Shebaa Farms status, Lebanese territorial sovereignty, and civilian protection architecture. It operates through Oman-facilitated consultations with participation from Lebanon, Israel, the Palestinian Authority, and the United Nations. Progress in the Regional Basket is desirable but not linked to Core Protocol compliance.

8.9 What This Annex Accomplishes

For the United States: The core U.S.-Iran deal is protected from being blown up by a proxy incident in Lebanon. Israel receives immediate security benefits from Day 1 (Hezbollah operational pause). The firewall prevents Tehran's "end the war on all fronts" demand from collapsing the nuclear deal.

For Iran: Iran demonstrates good faith by using its influence to de-escalate the most dangerous regional flashpoint. The operational pause is not disarmament or political concession — it is a structured, time-limited military de-escalation. Iran's support for Lebanese sovereignty is preserved through the Regional Basket.

For Israel: Immediate reduction in cross-border attacks. Formalized casualty threshold provides clarity on what triggers escalation. Direct channel to address Iranian weapons transfers to Hezbollah. Air strike moratorium is contingent and reversible.

Annex A: 72-Hour Implementation Timeline

TIME	IRANIAN ACTION	U.S. ACTION	VERIFICATION
Hour 0	Sign Protocol; activate enrichment freeze above 3.67%; begin HEU inventory	Sign Protocol; suspend offensive operations; release \$250M humanitarian tranche; freeze new sanctions	OLEM confirms freeze; Swiss escrow confirms transfer
Hour 12	IAEA inspectors arrive; physical inventory begins	Naval forces begin transition to stand-off posture	IAEA presence confirmed
Hour 24	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	OFAC general license for civilian aircraft parts (30 days)	IAEA confirms composition
Hour 48	Cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied; IRGC fast-attack craft withdraw to 5nm anchorage	Exempt humanitarian vessels from blockade enforcement	IAEA confirms seals; Omani naval observers confirm withdrawal
Hour 72	Dual-lock custody operational at declared facility; all enrichment above 3.67% frozen; JTCC established at Bandar Abbas	Naval stand-off complete; blockade reduced 50% for non-military cargo; Joint Hotline fully operational; LREP Secure Portal live	Joint Hotline certifies Day-One compliance; JTCC operational
Day 7	Convoy departs for Oman under armed IAEA guard; HEU in transit	Tranche 1 asset release (25% of frozen assets); agricultural/medical export licenses streamlined	IAEA confirms convoy; Swiss escrow confirms transfer; satellite tracking active
Day 14	HEU placed in IAEA custody at Muscat escrow facility; Fordow sealed; non-Natanz enrichment under IAEA seal	Comprehensive negotiation talks commence; all blockade restrictions lifted for non-military cargo	IAEA confirms Oman custody; IAEA certifies facility seals

Day 30	Continued clean compliance; Hormuz transit volumes at pre-crisis levels	Decision point: extend, deepen, or conclude	IAEA 30-day compliance report; Lloyd's List confirms transit
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Annex B: Domestic Narrative Guidance

Each Party requires a domestically defensible narrative. The following are factually accurate characterizations that both Parties may use without contradiction:

For the United States

- **"Weapons-grade uranium secured."** Iran's entire HEU stockpile is under international lock and key in Oman, with U.S. monitoring access via encrypted telemetry.
- **"Single enrichment facility."** Iran operates only one enrichment facility (Natanz) at 3.67%. Fordow is under IAEA seal.
- **"Hormuz is open, tolls are suspended."** Global energy flows resume without Iranian extortion.
- **"75% of assets held in reserve."** Iran receives only 25% as an initial tranche. The rest remains held for the comprehensive deal.
- **"No reparations paid."** All releases are performance-gated, not liability-based.
- **"We didn't move alone."** Every U.S. concession was matched by simultaneous, verified Iranian action.
- **"Military options preserved."** This is a 30-day emergency freeze, not a permanent commitment. All military options remain on the table.
- **"Firewall hardened."** Technical definitions prevent ambiguity. Bad faith in monitoring is a Tier 3 breach. Spoiler actors are isolated.

For Iran

- **"Sovereignty preserved."** The HEU never entered U.S. custody. It remains legally Iranian property, held in IAEA trust in a friendly Islamic state.
- **"NPT rights intact."** Enrichment to 3.67% continues. The limitation is interim, not surrender. No facility was destroyed.
- **"PGSA recognized."** Iran's Strait Authority is acknowledged as the operational coordination body for Hormuz transit.

- **"Blockade lifted."** U.S. offensive operations cease. Ports reopen. Oil exports can resume.
- **"Assets returning."** 25% of frozen sovereign property released within 14 days, with a pathway to more in comprehensive talks.
- **"We moved as equals."** Every Iranian step was matched by simultaneous U.S. action. Oman, not America, guards the material.
- **"Comprehensive deal still possible."** This emergency freeze preserves all positions for the permanent negotiation. Nothing is surrendered.
- **"Monitoring protected."** Good faith clause prevents U.S. technical sabotage of verification systems. Evidentiary standards prevent frivolous allegations.

Shared Message

Both Parties may truthfully state: *"We signed an emergency agreement that prevents war, secures the nuclear flashpoint, opens global energy flows, and delivers immediate humanitarian relief — while preserving all positions for the comprehensive negotiation."*

Annex D: Conflict Resolution Timeline and Default Clause

D.1 Tier 2 Incident — Exact 12-Hour Resolution Protocol

If a Tier 2 incident occurs, the foreign ministers (or their designated deputies holding full authority) shall take the following steps within the 12-hour resolution window:

HOURL	REQUIRED ACTION	RESPONSIBLE PARTY	VERIFICATION
H+0	JFMC issues formal Tier 2 notification to both Parties via LREP Secure Portal; Cooling-Off Period activates automatically	JFMC	Time-stamped portal entry
H+1	Both Parties acknowledge receipt through the Portal; designate their senior negotiator for the incident	Both Parties	Portal acknowledgement log

H+2	JFMC publishes preliminary fact summary with all available evidence; opens encrypted video bridge	JFMC	Published summary + bridge log
H+4	Both Parties submit written positions (max 500 words) through the Portal, including proposed resolution	Both Parties	Portal submission timestamps
H+6	First video consultation between designated senior negotiators, facilitated by Oman; goal: narrow points of disagreement	Both Parties + Oman	Facilitator's summary note
H+9	If disagreement persists, Facilitating State issues non-binding assessment with recommended resolution path	Facilitating State	Published assessment
H+12	Final decision point: (a) Parties agree on remediation plan; (b) Parties agree to extend consultation by mutual consent (max 24 hours); or (c) Tier 2 consequences activate	Both Parties	Joint statement or automatic trigger

D.2 Default Clause — Non-Response

If a Party fails to respond to a JFMC inquiry within the applicable time window (4 hours for Tier 1 acknowledgement; 12 hours for Tier 2 resolution), the following default procedures apply:

SCENARIO	DEFAULT EFFECT	LIMITATION
No response to Tier 1 evidence request within 4 hours	JFMC records allegation as "provisionally unchallenged"; triggers enhanced verification of the alleged activity	Does not constitute a legal finding of breach; non-responding Party may submit rebuttal within 48 hours
No response to Tier 2 consultation invitation within 12 hours	Tier 2 remediation window closes; Tier 2 consequences activate automatically; non-responding Party forfeits next scheduled benefit tranche	Humanitarian channel and military freeze remain in force regardless
No response to Cooling-Off Period activation	Cooling-Off remains binding on both Parties regardless of acknowledgement; JFMC continues investigation	No Party may take military action during Cooling-Off, acknowledged or not

No response to Reconstitution Conference invitation	Absence is recorded and published; UN Security Council notification under Chapter VI within 48 hours	Minimum Viable Core (Article VII.3) remains operative
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D.3 Emergency 24-Hour Extension for Technical Difficulties

If technical difficulties prevent the commencement or continuation of scheduled comprehensive negotiations:

- The Facilitating State may declare a 24-hour emergency extension
- Declaration must be published on the Shared Dashboard within 1 hour
- Extension is renewable once for an additional 24 hours
- All Protocol provisions remain in full force during the extension
- Either Party may object within 4 hours of declaration; objection triggers JFMC emergency session but does not void the extension

Instruments of Acceptance

Entry into Force

This Protocol enters into force immediately upon signature by the authorized representatives of both Parties. No domestic legislative approval is required for the initial 30-day period. The Protocol is deposited with the UN Secretary-General upon signature and constitutes a binding international commitment.

Signatures

In witness whereof, the undersigned, being duly authorized by their respective governments, have signed this Last Resort Emergency Protocol.

For the United States of America:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

Witness (Facilitating State):

Name: _____

Title: Sultanate of Oman / Swiss Confederation / Islamic Republic of Pakistan

Date: _____

Witness (International Organization):

Name: _____

Title: IAEA Director-General / UN Under-Secretary-General

Date: _____